



United States Department of the Interior

NATIONAL PARK SERVICE

Northeast Region

Rivers, Trails and Conservation Assistance Program

West Virginia Field Office

West Virginia University

P.O. Box 6125, 325 Percival Hall, Evansdale Drive

Morgantown, WV 26506-6125

IN REPLY REFER TO:
Derry Station Heritage Trail Links

June 8, 2011

Dr. Vince Troia, CEO
Ohio River Trail Council
1100 Pennsylvania Avenue
Monaca, PA 15061

Dear Dr. Troia,

Congratulations on your invitation to submit a project proposal for a grant from The Conservation Alliance. This letter offers my support for the project.

This is Year One of technical assistance to the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) from the National Park Service's Rivers, Trails & Conservation Assistance Program (NPS-RTCA).

The ORTC is working to develop a 41-mile multi-use land & water trail system along the Ohio River and its tributaries in southwestern Pennsylvania, known as the Ohio River Trail. In addition, the ORTC proposes the broad vision of a Tri-state Greenway System of interconnecting trails in Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. RTCA aims to assist ORTC in realizing this vision, with a focus on public involvement.

Together, we held a very successful Tri-State (18-county) workshop on March 29, 2011 with about 85 trail planners and managers participating. I have assisted with guidance on the Feasibility Studies for both the North and South Shore Trails. There is much work to be done to get the trail segments on the ground, and to acquire and protect needed properties for this purpose.

Please consider the ORTC request for funding assistance to launch an active campaign of direct citizen action to purchase, protect, and remediate the 69 acre tract of land in Ohioville, Pennsylvania. This acquisition would greatly improve the conservation efforts and expansion of the Ohio River Trail.

Please feel free to contact me at 304-293-7528, or peggy_pings@nps.gov.

Sincerely,

Peggy Pings
Outdoor Recreation Planner
NPS-RTCA www.nps.gov/rtca